

Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: identify the source verse and explain the principle.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* (IAST: Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam; lit. “the world is one family” — Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71”)

Primary source (today’s reading)

From *Mahā Upaniṣad* 6.71–73 — *vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam* — see [sources.md](#).

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **The verse.** From *Mahā Upaniṣad* 6.71–73: > *ayaṁ nijaḥ paro veti gaṇanā laghu-cetasām* / > *udāra-caritānām tu vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam* //
Translation: “‘This is mine, that is another’s’ — such reckoning is for the narrow-minded. For the great-hearted, the entire earth is one family.”
2. **Etymology.** *Vasudhā* — earth (literally “wealth-holder”). *Eva* — indeed. *Kuṭumbakam* — diminutive of *kuṭumba* (family), so “little family” or “the dear family.”
3. **Source clarification.** Also widely cited as appearing in the *Pañcatantra* and in *Hitopadeśa*. The *Mahā Upaniṣad* attestation is most commonly cited in academic contexts.
4. **The ecological reading.** Not just a humanist statement — it’s a principle of moral inclusion that extends to all life, all of nature. Read with the modern climate crisis in view, it becomes a foundational text for Indian environmental ethics.

5. **Critical caveat.** Pre-modern India was NOT universally eco-friendly. Forest clearance, soil degradation, and over-hunting also occurred. The TEXT articulates an ideal; the PRACTICE varied. Distinguish ethical framework from historical record.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).